



### Challenge

As Chewy rapidly expanded its supplier network, maintaining operational consistency, visibility, and accountability across more than 3,000 active vendors became increasingly complex. The Vendor Compliance organization was responsible for governing supplier execution across EDI transactions, transportation performance, packaging standards, appointment compliance, fill rates, and fulfillment quality through a comprehensive 94-page Vendor Compliance Manual.

While standards existed, supplier performance data was fragmented across multiple systems and operational teams. Leadership lacked a unified framework to identify the root causes of recurring supplier defects, prioritize operational risks, and drive consistent accountability across the network. At the same time, fulfillment operations, transportation teams, merchandising, and supply chain leaders needed greater visibility into the operational issues driving labor inefficiencies, inventory inaccuracies, service disruptions, and unnecessary costs.

The business required more than a compliance program. It needed a scalable supplier performance management capability that could improve operational execution, create transparency, influence supplier behavior, and support long-term growth without compromising strategic supplier relationships.

### Approach

As the leader of Vendor Compliance and Operations, I transformed the organization from a reactive compliance function into a data-driven supplier governance program focused on performance improvement and operational excellence.

I led a cross-functional team of Program Managers, Business Intelligence Engineers, and Analysts while partnering closely with Fulfillment Operations, Transportation, Supply Chain, Finance, Merchandising, Accounts Payable, and Vendor Management teams. Together, we redesigned the operating model to align policy governance, supplier performance measurement, reporting, and executive accountability into a single framework.

A key component of the transformation was modernizing how supplier performance was measured and managed. I oversaw governance across 22 primary compliance metrics and more than 40 supporting sub-metrics while launching a new enterprise chargeback platform covering 10 operational defect categories. This created a standardized framework for measuring supplier execution across EDI accuracy, fill rates, appointment compliance, transportation performance, packaging quality, damages, overages, and operational reliability.

To improve visibility and decision-making, I led the development of supplier scorecards, executive dashboards, root-cause reporting, and recurring business reviews. These tools enabled leadership teams to identify recurring defects, prioritize corrective actions, and focus resources on the operational issues creating the greatest impact across the network. I also conducted more than 100 executive-level supplier reviews, driving accountability, performance improvement plans, and long-term supplier investment strategies.

## **Results**

The transformation delivered measurable business and operational outcomes:

- Generated more than \$20 million in annual business value.
- Delivered approximately \$12 million in incremental annual revenue through a redesigned supplier accountability framework.
- Reduced supplier defect rates by more than 30%.
- Improved labor efficiency by 15% through process improvements and operational standardization.
- Increased EDI compliance by 15%.
- Improved carrier OTIF performance by 5%.
- Increased packaging and dunnage compliance by 8%.
- Conducted 100+ executive supplier reviews, driving more than \$30 million in supplier automation, quality, and operational investments.
- Standardized governance across 24 compliance specialists and 3,000+ supplier relationships.

## **Impact**

What began as a compliance program evolved into a strategic supplier governance capability. By combining policy governance, operational analytics, supplier accountability, and executive engagement, the program created greater transparency, improved operational performance, and strengthened supplier partnerships across the network.

Most importantly, the initiative established a scalable framework for continuous improvement that reduced operational variability, improved supply chain reliability, and enabled sustainable growth across one of the largest supplier ecosystems in the pet retail industry.